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Emre Oral

CONTACT INFORMATION

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Household Finance, Applied Microeconomics

REFERENCES

Prof. Arthur Seibold	**Prof. Eckhard Janeba**	**Prof. Antonio Ciccone**
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EDUCATION

2021 - Present	Ph.D. in Economics, **University of Mannheim** Research visit at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, 12/2024 - 01/2025
2021	M.S. Quantitative Economics, **Ludwig Maximilian University Munich** Graduate exchange student at UC Berkeley, 2021
2019	B.S. Mathematics; B.A. Economics, **Koç University** Exchange student, Singapore Management University, 2018

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

◇ "Why Do Retirees Retain Wealth? Quasi-Experimental Evidence from the Netherlands"

Abstract: I study why retired households draw down so little wealth, a puzzling empirical pattern known as the *retirement savings puzzle*. Using population-wide administrative data from the Netherlands, I investigate the role of long-term-care expenditure risk and bequest motives in explaining this pattern. For identification, I exploit statutory kinks in the Dutch policy rules governing costs of care, and examine life events that change the set of potential heirs. I find both motives are important drivers of old-age wealth. A marginal euro increase in care costs increases annual wealth accumulation by 45 cents, implying a precautionary stock of up to 22 percent of

wealth. On the bequest side, losing an adult child decreases wealth by 5.5 percent, while gaining an unexpected grandchild increases it by 1.2 percent five years after the event. Findings provide evidence of an *intentional* bequest motive directed toward particular heirs. Together, the two motives account for up to 40 percent of old-age wealth, but leave a substantial portion unexplained.

Working Papers

◇ "The Social Multiplier of Pension Reform" (with Simon Rabaté and Arthur Seibold), *CEPR Discussion Paper No. 21472.*

Abstract: We study how social forces in families, neighborhoods and workplaces shape retirement behavior. To estimate causal retirement spillovers between individuals, we exploit a pension reform in the Netherlands that creates exogenous variation in peers' retirement ages, and we use administrative data on the full Dutch population. We find large spillovers in couples, primarily due to women reacting to their husband's retirement choices. Average spillovers among siblings, neighbors, and coworkers are modest; however, consistent with homophily in social interactions, sizable effects arise between similar individuals in these groups. Additional evidence suggests both leisure complementarities and the transmission of social norms as mechanisms behind retirement spillovers. Our findings imply that pension reforms have a large social multiplier, amplifying their overall impact on retirement behavior by at least 42%.

◇ "The Dynamics of Reference Point Formation: Evidence from a Dutch Pension Reform" (with Arthur Seibold)

Abstract: We study how individuals form reference points when public policy shifts a salient threshold. We exploit a pension reform in the Netherlands that gradually raised the Normal Retirement Age (NRA) from 65 to 67 across successive birth cohorts, and we use administrative data on the full Dutch population. Using a bunching approach, we find that a large retirement spike moves in lockstep with the legislated NRA, even though the NRA is not linked to any financial incentive to retire. In the short run, however, retirement behavior is sticky: among the first affected cohorts, large residual bunching persists at the old NRA, which dissipates over the following three years. We interpret these patterns in a model of reference-dependent retirement behavior. Model calibrations suggest that one third of workers exhibit sticky reference points in the short-run, while two third immediately adopt the new NRA as a reference point. After three years, virtually all individuals adjust their reference points. Our findings imply that the large behavioral impacts of increasing the NRA materialize relatively quickly.

Work in Progress

◇ "Privacy Demand under Public Tax Disclosure: Empirical Evidence from Turkish Top Taxpayers" (with Oytun Tükenmez)

Abstract: We study demand for privacy in a tax system with public disclosure of taxpayer information. While prior research focuses on the effect of disclosure on tax compliance, less is known about the privacy costs on taxpayers. We exploit a unique setting in Turkey, where tax authorities publish annual rankings of top individual and corporate taxpayers. Importantly, taxpayers can withhold their identifying information. We interpret this nondisclosure choice as a revealed preference for privacy over public recognition. Using a novel dataset of nearly 100,000 taxpayers over 25 years, we document a striking increase in nondisclosure, from below 10% in the 2000s to above 60% in the 2020s. Nondisclosure is particularly common among the highest-ranked

individuals, who attract greater public attention, while these patterns are weaker among firms. Preliminary results suggest that privacy demand is higher in more populous provinces and those with less support for the ruling party, but we find little evidence linking it to subsequent tax-base growth. Overall, our findings demonstrate privacy demand increased markedly in recent decades and highlight public attention as an important factor.

Publications

- ◇ "Reproducibility and robustness of economics and political science research" (as contributing author; large replication project with >340 co-authors)

  Nature 652 (8108), 151-156, April 2026

PRESENTATIONS

*: Scheduled

2026	ZEW Public Finance Conference; LMU Munich; IIPF Annual Congress Lisbon; ZEW Taxation Conference (Poster); Econometric Society Winter Meeting*
2025	EEA Annual Congress Bordeaux; Toulouse School of Economics (BID Workshop); WZB Berlin Workshop on the Economics of Ageing and Pensions
2024	ZEW Public Finance Conference; IIPF Annual Congress Prague; 16th Winter Workshop in Economics at Koç University
2023	EEA Annual Congress Barcelona

TEACHING

University of Mannheim

2025	Business Economics I (Master's), Teaching Assistant, *CDSE Teaching Award 2026*
2024 - 2025	Microeconomics III (PhD), Teaching Assistant
2024 - 2025	Microeconomics II (PhD), Teaching Assistant
2022 - 2024	Mathematics for social scientists (PhD), Instructor
2023	Microeconomics A (Undergraduate), Teaching Assistant

Koç University

2019	Game Theory (Undergraduate), Tutor
2018 - 2019	Introduction to Statistics (Undergraduate), Teaching Assistant
2018	Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate), Teaching Assistant

AWARDS and SCHOLARSHIPS

2026	CDSE Teaching Award
	LGFG Bridging Scholarship (Aug - Dec, €1,500/month), University of Mannheim
2025	Research Data Grant (€9,974), University of Mannheim
2021 - 2023	Mannheim GESS Doctoral Fellowship
2019 - 2021	TEV / DAAD Master's Scholarship

MISCELLANEOUS

Other Activities	Coordinator of the ENTER network for seminar visits
	Co-organizer of Mannheim PhD Seminar
Programming	Stata, R
Languages	English (fluent), Turkish (native), German (intermediate, B1)
Citizenship	Turkey